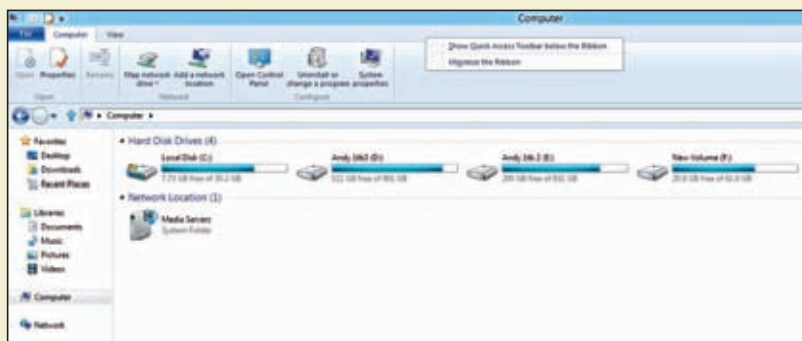




Explorer with the new Ribbon interface

accessible directly from within the OS. You can also use Microsoft's own Windows 7 to USB tool from <http://bit.ly/ypAWf>. Point the EXE file to the location of the .iso file and create a bootable USB drive with Windows 8. Alternatively, you can also burn the ISO file to a DVD and use that to install the OS.

The installation process is identical to Windows 7's and all you need to do is keep clicking next at each question. During the installation, you'll be presented with an option to customise the features; don't worry about this unless you're worried about privacy. The settings provided will allow you to customise the way your OS installation sends data about your usage to Microsoft.

After installation you'll see a start screen where you get to

choose the OS you want to boot into. Windows 8 Developer Preview is usually set as the default. This is alright if you're going to use Windows 8 as the default OS, but if you boot into Windows 7 regularly you'll want to set that as the default OS. This is because if you get to the Windows 8 boot screen and then boot into Windows 7, your system will reboot and only then boot into Windows 7.

Working with the Metro UI

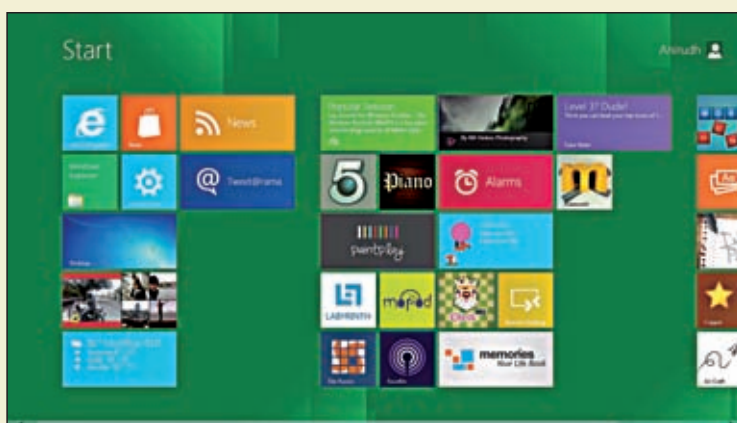
On boot up, you're greeted with the Windows Metro UI home screen. This UI is actually quite sufficient to manage your day to day PC usage. The desktop is still present and can

be accessed using the Desktop tile. This home screen works pretty much like the home screen on any Windows phone or mp3 player. Any time you hit the "Windows" key on the keyboard, you will be presented with this screen.

Hit the key again, and you will return to what you were doing previously.

Multi-tasking in Windows 8

Windows 8 now has a different take on multi-tasking, unlike Windows 7, pressing the Windows key now suspends the active application you were working on and presents you with the home screen. These suspended tasks are still present in the background and consume RAM, but don't consume CPU resources. Opening the task manager ([Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del]) will present you with a list of the running and suspended apps.



The new Metro UI brings a lot of Windows Phone 7-like tiles

The standard windows 7 shortcuts still work. The Aero Flip 3D using Windows+Tab has now been modified to present you with a shuffling animation.

You can choose to suspend those that you wish or you feel are consuming too many resources.

Task-switching, while it can be done via [Alt] + [Tab] or [Windows] + [Tab], can also be done via a mouse or touch input. If you bring your mouse to the extreme left of your screen and click, you will switch apps. You can also click and drag the applications out. If you pause with the application partially dragged out, you can pin it to the side of the screen as a vertical panel and still continue to work on your other apps. This is especially useful if you want to, say, keep track of your tweets or stocks while working. You can also click and drag apps and then drag them back to the left side and drag out again to shuffle through all the active apps. Prima facie, this may sound very complicated, but it's



Internet Explorer 10 as viewed in the new Metro UI